

F5 Daily Briefing — Wednesday, May 13, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

8

ANNOUNCEMENTS

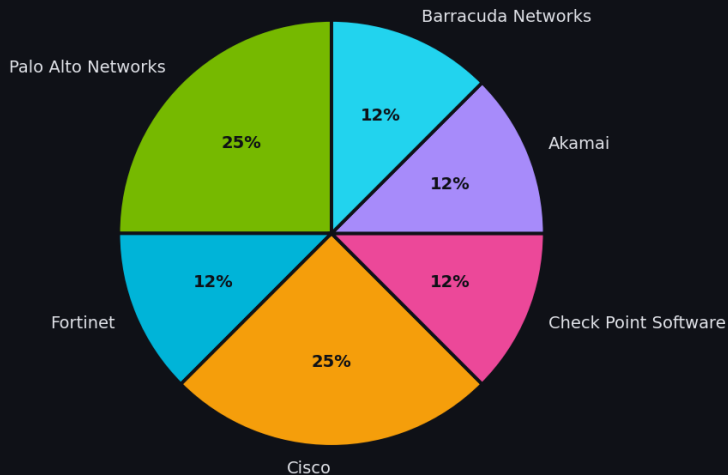
6

ACTIVE

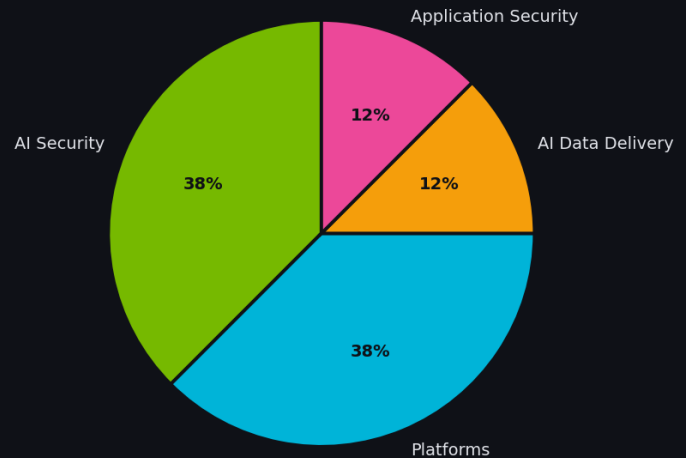
4

ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (8)

ACQUISITION

Akamai

2026-05-14

Platforms

Akamai Announces Intent to Acquire LayerX for AI Usage Control

Akamai announced its intent to acquire LayerX, a browser-based AI usage control and secure enterprise browser provider, extending Akamai's Zero Trust portfolio into the browser. LayerX supports mainstream browsers without requiring infrastructure changes and provides real-time visibility and control over employee AI tool usage, prompts, file uploads, and SaaS applications. Akamai positions the deal as addressing AI usage control as a top 2026 priority and complementing existing Zero Trust offerings at the point of AI use. The acquisition is expected to be dilutive to non-GAAP EPS for fiscal 2026, with LayerX projected to reach roughly \$100 million in ARR at year-end.

Source: <https://in.marketscreener.com/news/akamai-technologies-announces-intent-to-acquire-layerx-advancing-its-workforce-security-strategy-wi-ce7f5bdda8cf426>

THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

Palo Alto Networks

2026-05-13

AI Security

Rethinking Data Security in the AI Era

Palo Alto Networks published a strategic post arguing that traditional data security tools are insufficient in the AI era. Rather than adding more point solutions, enterprises should build an AI-ready foundation on three blocks: modern connectivity, metadata context, and normalized classification. The post pushes a policy-first approach where data policies are harmonized before automation, and a data-centric threat model that protects data assets and controls rather than just monitoring users or agents. It also notes that ephemeral agent identities defy traditional IAM, complicating attribution and least privilege.

Source: <https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/cloud-security/data-security-ai-agentic-foundation/>

INDUSTRY WARNING**Palo Alto Networks**

2026-05-13

AI Security

AI-Driven Cyberattacks Will Be 'New Norm' in Months, Warns Palo Alto Networks

Palo Alto Networks tech chief Lee Klarich warned that AI-driven cyberattacks will become the new norm within 3-5 months, urging immediate, intensified defenses including virtual patching. The piece highlights how advanced models like Anthropic Mythos and OpenAI GPT-5.5-Cyber are enabling exploitation of unknown software vulnerabilities, with attackers already leveraging available AI tools. Palo Alto plans to roll out early defense capabilities soon and participated in collaborative testing with Mythos.

Source: <https://www.cnn.com/2026/05/13/palo-alto-ai-cyberattacks-mythos-gpt.html>

SECURITY ADVISORY**Fortinet**

2026-05-13

Platforms

Fortinet Patches Two Critical RCE Flaws in FortiAuthenticator and FortiSandbox

Fortinet released patches on May 13 for two critical remote code execution flaws: CVE-2026-44277 in FortiAuthenticator (improper access control) and CVE-2026-26083 in FortiSandbox (missing authorization). Both carry a CVSS 9.1 score and allow unauthenticated attackers to execute arbitrary code via crafted HTTP requests. Recommended fixes are FortiAuthenticator 6.5.7, 6.6.9, or 8.0.3, and FortiSandbox 4.4.9 or 5.0.2. Fortinet noted no confirmed in-the-wild exploitation but warned that past Fortinet RCE flaws have been actively exploited; additional patches for higher- and medium-severity vulnerabilities in FortiOS and FortiAP were also released.

Source: <https://www.csoonline.com/article/4170993/fortinet-fixes-two-critical-rce-flaws-in-fortiauthenticator-and-fortisandbox.html>

OPEN SOURCE RELEASE**Cisco**

2026-05-13

AI Security

Cisco Open-Sources Foundry Security Spec for Agentic AI Security

Cisco open-sourced its Foundry Security Spec, a model- and stack-agnostic blueprint for building agentic security evaluation systems. The spec defines eight agent roles, five extension roles, a finding lifecycle, and roughly 130 functional requirements, paired with a 'constitution' artifact codifying eleven inviolable principles. Built to work with GitHub's spec-kit, it aims to replace noisy, unverifiable LLM outputs with bounded, auditable findings and a clear done signal. Cisco positions the framework as a way for security teams to evaluate frontier models like Mythos and GPT-5.5-Cyber against a repeatable, industry-shareable standard.

Source: <https://www.networkworld.com/article/4170307/cisco-open-sources-agentic-ai-security-spec.html>

EVENT / PRODUCT SHOWCASE**Cisco**

2026-05-13

AI Data Delivery

Cisco Showcases AI-Native Data Center Architecture at ONUG Dallas 2026

At ONUG Dallas 2026 on May 13-14, Cisco demonstrated how AI-native networks securely scale enterprise AI workloads in the agentic era. Sessions led by Tom Gillis and other Cisco leaders covered AI-native architecture blueprints, AgenticOps as a new operational model, and hybrid AI infrastructures balancing public AI services with private models. Innovations highlighted include Nexus One, AI Canvas with AgenticOps, real-time monitoring, mixed-mode load balancing, and GPU optimization across the data center fabric for AI workloads, alongside guardrails and data controls for autonomous AI agents.

Source: <https://blogs.cisco.com/datacenter/cisco-at-onug-dallas-2026-securing-the-ai-data-center-in-the-agentic-era>

THREAT RESEARCH**Check Point Software**

2026-05-13

Platforms

Check Point Reveals Inside Operations of 'The Gentlemen' Ransomware Gang After Leak

Check Point Research published a deep analysis of The Gentlemen, a ransomware-as-a-service group active since mid-2025, after a May 4 backend database leak exposed internal operations. The group operates with about nine core operators led by administrator zeta88 ('hastalamuerte'), who built the management panel in three days with AI coding helpers. The Gentlemen recruits affiliates with a 90/10 revenue split, exploits exposed VPN/firewall infrastructure (CVE-2024-55591, CVE-2025-32433, CVE-2025-33073), and listed ~332 victims in the first five months of 2026. Leaked screenshots include a negotiated \$190,000 ransom from an initial \$250,000 demand.

Source: <https://research.checkpoint.com/2026/thus-spoke-the-gentlemen/>

THREAT REPORT**Barracuda Networks**

2026-05-13

Application Security

Barracuda 2026 Email Threats Report: AI and Phishing-as-a-Service Reshape Email Attacks

Barracuda Networks released its 2026 Email Threats Report, analyzing 3.1+ billion emails from January 2026. Phishing accounts for 48% of malicious email activity, and 34% of companies see at least one account takeover monthly. Over 10% of HTML attachments are malicious, 70% of malicious PDFs contain QR codes linking to phishing sites, and 90% of high-volume phishing campaigns rely on phishing-as-a-service kits. Barracuda emphasizes a shift from file-based to URL/QR-driven delivery and calls for layered email security, identity protection, rapid detection, and automated response to counter AI-driven social engineering.

Source: <https://securitybrief.in/story/ai-fuels-rise-in-phishing-attacks-barracuda-finds>